

THE DARKNESS II

SKOAR!

TWO DEMONIC ARMS + GUNS =

LOADS OF FUN!

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The Darkness II is a profanity laden tour-de-force something along the lines of Sopranos meets Exorcist meets Kill Bill. The game takes place two years after the events of the previous game, Jackie Estacado, our protagonist is trying to come to terms with the death of his girlfriend and at the same time is able to exercise a measure of control over The Darkness, which manifests itself as two demonic arms sprouting from his shoulders. Just when things begin to look up, he's pitted into an all-out gang war against a shady rival faction called The Brotherhood.

What follows is absolute mayhem, as Jackie goes about ripping people apart,

some major plot twists, backstabbing and double-dealing when demons and mafia are involved but alas, the plot is nearly linear. Not that we're downplaying the scary parts, the heebie-jeebies come by the dozen and the game manages to haunt you long after you've completed it.

The Darkness II is a decent enough shooter for sure, you have the usual arsenal of pistols, SMGs, rifles and shotguns at your disposal, but its the two grisly demonic appendages with a taste for human heart that redefine "pwned". You can use them to lob almost anything, including chairs, drums, rotor blades, etc., and also to stun the enemies as well as slice and dice carcasses. Then are the executions that everyone is raving about, among the particularly gruesome and depraved ones



is one where you grab the unfortunate opponent's leg and then proceed to rip out the said foe's spinal column from his posterior. All these actions earn you "dark essence" which you spend enhancing existing skills and acquiring new ones. Bear in mind, this game is not for the squeamish, the amount of gore, blood and cuss words could even make Quentin Tarantino blush.

The sound effects are well, nearly perfect and you can actually hear bones and cartilage snap and rupture. Not to mention the fantastic voice acting and background music, Mike Patton as the

turning the city into an abattoir, trying to find a reason behind The Brotherhood's attacks and the true intentions of The Darkness. The story is also much more personal and at times touching, as compared to its predecessor. One does expect

Verdict

There isn't much replay value as at some point, making human shish kebabs loses its charm, and the only thing close to multiplayer is the Vendettas story which allows you to play the missions co-operatively. All in all if you have a stomach for violence and enjoy tearing up people into little pieces, want a little gun play but can settle without multiplayer, then The Darkness II isn't a game to be missed.

MOAR!

- » **Developer:** Digital Extremes
- » **Publisher:** 2K Games
- » **Genre:** FPS, Horror
- » **Platforms:** PS3, Xbox360, PC
- » **Price:** ₹999 (PC), ₹2,799 (Xbox 360), ₹2,499 (PS3)



Darkness is an absolute treat. Visually the game is brilliant and makes full use of cell-shading techniques.

The game is undoubtedly well-made but it has got its own share of problems. The AI is absolutely horrible and even the boss fights are lame. At normal difficulty, the game is a breeze with only the advanced difficulty posing a challenge. Another surprising thing about The Darkness II is its length, its excruciatingly small. The single-player campaign offers about six hours of gameplay. Apart from the online/offline Vendettas side story about four Darkness mercenaries working for Jackie, which takes place parallel to the single-player story line, the game has nothing else to offer. ✱